

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 696

By Jackson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the members of the 168th Military Police Battalion, Tennessee Army National Guard, for meritorious service in support of the Joint Task Force-Southern Border mission.

WHEREAS, our nation was founded by individuals willing to place service above self in defense of liberty and the rule of law, and the Volunteer State has long taken pride in the men and women who answer that call through faithful military service; and

WHEREAS, thousands of Tennesseans continue this proud tradition through service in the Tennessee Army National Guard, providing critical support to state and federal missions at home and abroad; and

WHEREAS, the members of the 168th Military Police Battalion, Tennessee Army National Guard, served with distinction, discipline, and professionalism in support of the Joint Task Force-Southern Border mission, a complex and demanding operation conducted over thirteen months in defense of national sovereignty and public safety; and

WHEREAS, under the command of its battalion leadership of Lieutenant Colonel Robert E. Crowley, the 168th Military Police Battalion, headquartered in Dyersburg, Tennessee, assumed command of six companies of approximately 650 soldiers to support operations along a 300-mile operational front extending from Laredo, Texas to Brownsville, Texas; and

WHEREAS, throughout the mission, the Battalion executed continuous, multi-domain security operations resulting in over 14,000 detections, turn-backs, and assisted apprehensions in coordination with federal, state, and local law enforcement partners; and

WHEREAS, the Battalion conducted more than thirty counter-unmanned aerial system engagements and mitigations across the Rio Grande Valley, enhancing air domain awareness and denying adversary reconnaissance and trafficking operations; and

WHEREAS, the 168th Military Police Battalion successfully planned and executed four division-approved named operations targeting cartel-controlled hot spots, each operating continuously, significantly disrupting transnational criminal activity; and

WHEREAS, the Battalion conducted ten coordinated engagements with Mexican military forces, strengthening cross-border communication, de-escalation, and operational synchronization; and

WHEREAS, the Battalion supported riverine operations that emplaced 110 buoys in support of National Defense Areas along the Rio Grande River and adjacent islands, contributing directly to improved terrain denial and force protection; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Battalion operated as part of an integrated, multi-agency task force alongside the U.S. Border Patrol, the United States Coast Guard, the Texas National Guard, Mexican military forces, and local law enforcement agencies, demonstrating exceptional interoperability and professionalism; and

WHEREAS, the 168th Military Police Battalion established and maintained thirty-one active manned border sites, supported a total of sixty-six dynamic operational sites, operated five active camera rooms, and conducted routine dismounted patrols, providing persistent surveillance and physical presence across the area of operations; and

WHEREAS, through these efforts, the Battalion consistently distinguished itself as a disciplined, adaptable, and mission-focused organization, often relied upon to establish operational standards and best practices across the Joint Task Force area of responsibility; and

WHEREAS, having honorably completed this demanding mission, the members of the 168th Military Police Battalion returned home having upheld the highest traditions of the Tennessee Army National Guard and the United States Army; and

WHEREAS, the service of these soldiers reflects great credit upon themselves, their families, the Tennessee Army National Guard, and the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend the members of the 168th Military Police Battalion, Tennessee Army National Guard, for their meritorious service in support of the Joint Task Force-Southern Border mission, and we express our profound appreciation for their dedication, professionalism, and exemplary service to the State of Tennessee and the Nation.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.